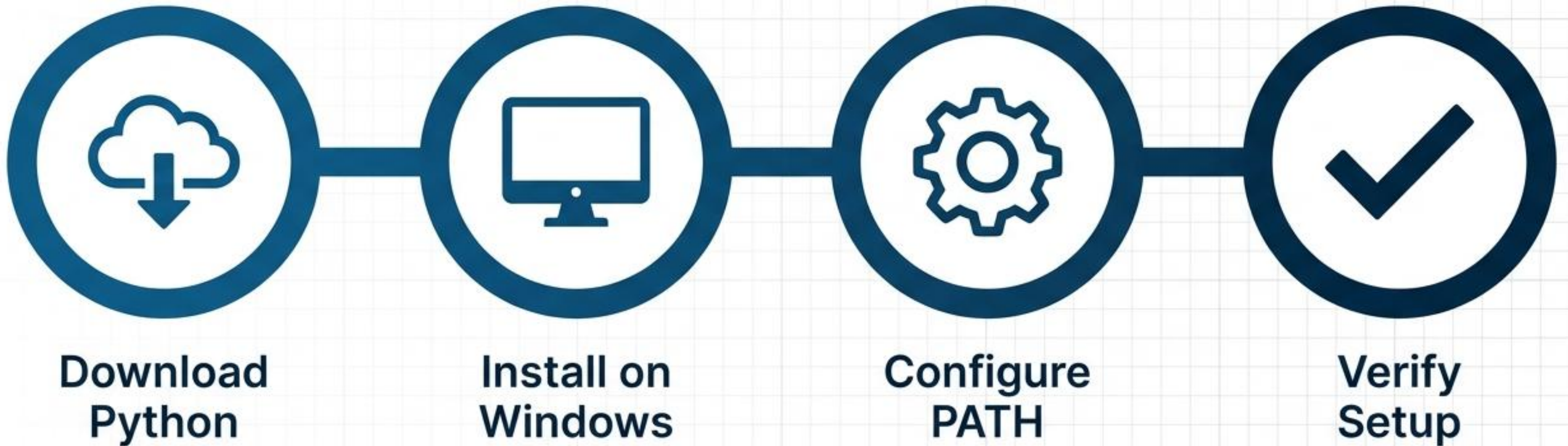




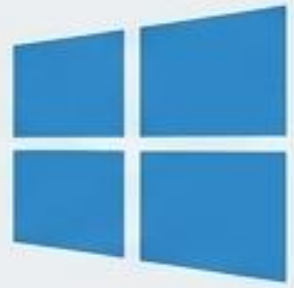
Python Installation & Setup

Module 3, Lesson 3 | Building Your Programming Environment

The four stages of our installation mission



System requirements for a local Python environment



Windows 10 or
Windows 11



Stable internet
connection



Administrator
permissions



500 MB of free
disk space



Security Note: Always download directly from www.python.org. Avoid third-party sites to ensure safety and get the latest updates.

Sourcing the official Python installer



1

Open browser to
`www.python.org`

2

Navigate to the
Downloads menu

3

Select the latest stable
Windows version

Executing the installer and configuring PATH



Step 1: Check the **PATH** box (**Crucial!**)

Step 2: Click **Install Now**

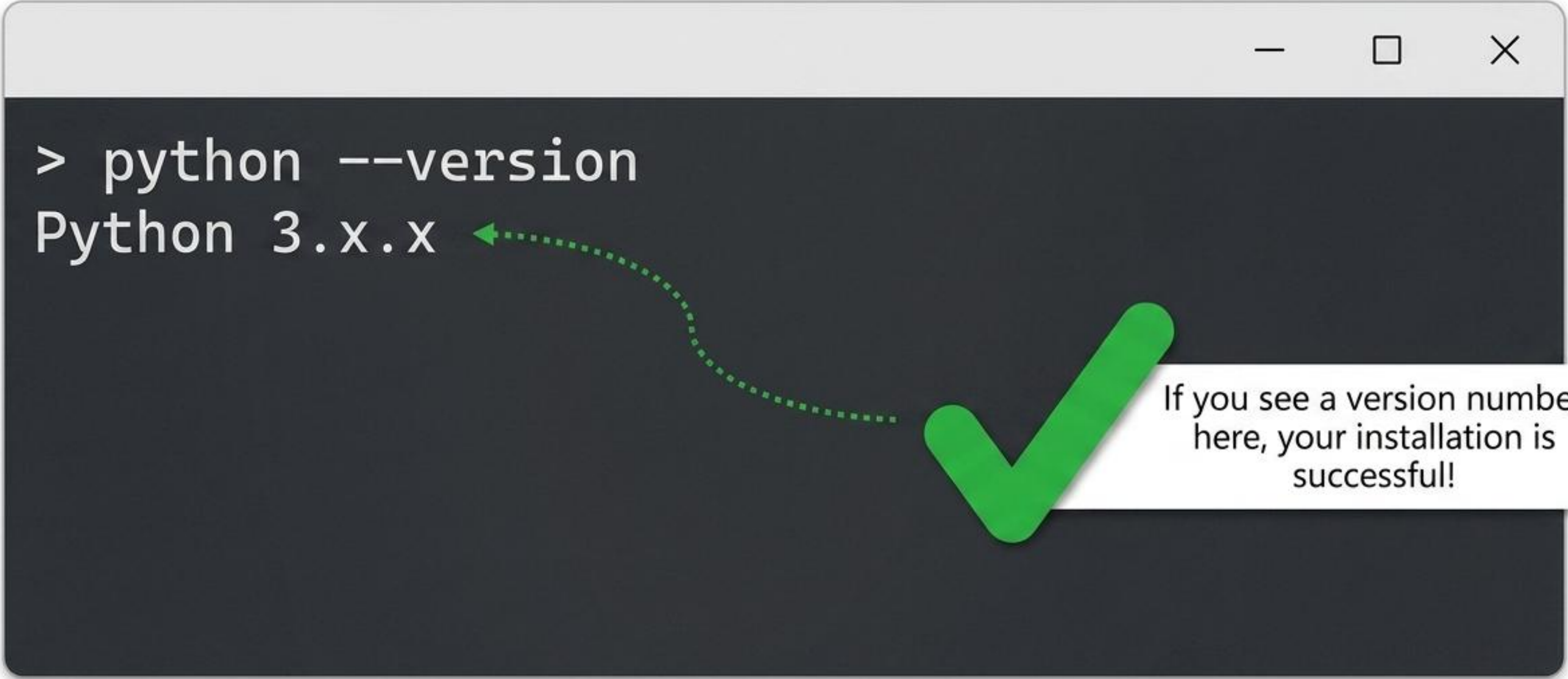
Step 3: Wait for completion, then click **Close**

How the operating system locates Python



PATH is a Windows system setting that acts like a map. It tells your Command Prompt exactly where Python lives so you can run commands from anywhere. Without it, Windows will not recognize Python commands.

Verifying the installation via Command Prompt



```
> python --version  
Python 3.x.x
```

If you see a version number here, your installation is successful!

Diagnostic matrix for common installation errors

 Symptom	 Diagnosis	 Solution
python command not recognized	Python wasn't added to PATH, or the Command Prompt needs a restart.	Restart Command Prompt. If it fails, reinstall and check the PATH box.
Installed the wrong version	Downloaded an incorrect or outdated file.	Redownload the latest stable version directly from python.org.
Multiple Python versions installed	Old installations are conflicting with the new one.	Remove older versions via Windows Settings and keep the latest.

Your computer is now a Python programming machine



Downloaded securely from the official source



Installed successfully on Windows



Configured system PATH for global access



Verified functionality via Command Prompt

Next up: Writing your first Python program



Install Visual Studio Code
& the Python Extension.

```
>_  
print("Hello, World!")
```

Create and run your very
first Python file.

Our Python programming journey officially begins in the next lesson.